

Slava I. Maslennikov

Principal Engineer & Engineering Leader · Cloud Platforms, Applied AI



About me

Founder of **Cool Consulting, LLC**: cloud platforms and applied AI. Previously engineering leader in Cloud Infrastructure Modernization. **Worldwide** delivery, new offerings, **teams that scale**.

References

Senior RM Bri Tomasullo
Staff Eng. Mike Davis
CTO Miles Ward
Sr. Director Scott VDP

Languages

Russian ● ● ● ● ●
English ● ● ● ● ●
Spanish ● ● ● ● ●
French ● ● ● ● ●

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 Seattle, WA, USA

Full job history available on LinkedIn.

SKILLS

Leadership: People management, hiring, coaching, distributed teams, productization, training
Cloud & platform: GCP, AWS, Kubernetes, Cloud Run, Terraform, CI/CD, IaC, SRE, incident response
Applied AI: LLM apps, RAG and hybrid retrieval, LangGraph, evaluation suites, load testing
Tools: Go, Python, Bash, D2, $\LaTeX$, Markdown; LoRa and Meshtastic hardware

TALKS, WORKSHOPS & PUBLICATIONS

2026	BSides Las Vegas	TALK	Broadcast, Don't Chat
2026	BSides Seattle	WORKSHOP	Hands-on Meshtastic
2026	SCaLE 23x	WORKSHOP	Long-range cheap comms through Meshtastic
2025	BSidesPDX	WORKSHOP	Hands-on Meshtastic
2025	BSidesPDX	TALK	From walkie-talkies to Meshtastic
2025	BSides Las Vegas	TALK	Can you hear me now?
2025	LayerOne	TALK	Engineering Culture
2022	SADA blog	ARTICLE	Interviewing Engineers
2021	SADA blog	ARTICLE	Write Excellent Code

EXPERIENCE

2024–now



Founder & Principal Engineer

COOL CONSULTING, LLC · Seattle, WA

- Boutique consultancy for cloud platforms and applied AI; every engagement from referral. Client work under NDA; write-ups and open source at coolconsulting.lol/projects.
- Enterprise RAG assistant on GCP (2026–): FastAPI, LangGraph, Claude, hybrid pgvector + full-text retrieval (RRF), MFA, region-pinned data. Cut p95 time-to-first-token from 160s to 10s at 40 concurrent users; scope extended twice.
- Security audit & remediation (2026): 66 findings rated critical–low; criticals closed within hours of approval.
- GCP & Workspace migration (2025): led PM, leadership, and SRE with an overseas partner; 30 TB across 35 seats; ~500 → 10 GCP projects; staged off-peak cutovers.
- Music streaming platform (2025): laptop prototype to multi-env GCP in Terraform; Cloud Run + HTTPS LB; Fastly CDN with HMAC-signed private media; keyless CI (WIF).

2021–2025



Senior Engineering Manager

SADA · ASSOCIATE MGR 2021 → MGR 2021 → SENIOR MGR 2022 · Remote

- Opened a Yerevan, Armenia office; interviewed 100+ candidates to hire ~25 engineers, billable in 1.5 weeks; aligned delivery across the US, Canada, India, Armenia, and UK.
- Converted bench time into 15+ reusable Terraform modules and internal platforms, 5 packaged Infrastructure Modernization offerings (scope, packaging, GTM), and 20+ Google Cloud certifications; owned pursuits and closed engagements.
- Sustained Google Cloud Infrastructure Modernization Partner Specialization through biennial audits over 7 years with 15+ customer references and case studies; trained cohorts of 10–50.

2018–2021



Senior Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

INFRASTRUCTURE MODERNIZATION AT SADA · Remote

- Delivered 10+ migrations and greenfield builds across AWS, GCP, and Kubernetes; embedded with clients to containerize 20+ workloads onto cloud-native runtimes.
- Built and operated CI/CD and Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Ansible, Chef, Puppet); automated internal workflows (Zapier, Bash, Go); mentored peers.

2017–2018



Senior Site Reliability Engineer

GRINDR, LLC · Los Angeles, CA

- AWS as code (Terraform); release automation with Jenkins; toil reduction with Ansible; custom RPM/DEB packaging; fleet migration from legacy Ubuntu to CentOS.

2016–2017



Platform Engineer

NORDSTROMRACK.COM · Los Angeles, CA

- Hybrid AWS and GCP with Terraform; built a containerized Nginx routing layer; provisioning with Puppet, Chef, and Foreman; migrated fleet config from Puppet to Chef.